

Exercise C (Page 38)

State whether the underlined words are -ing adjectives or gerunds. Point out their objects, if any.

1. Finding fault with other people is an irritating habit of his.

Answer: Finding – Gerund (subject of is); Object: fault (with other people).

Irritating – -ing adjective (qualifies habit).

2. I like dreaming impossible dreams.

Answer: Dreaming – Gerund (object of like); Object: impossible dreams.

3. The speeding truck knocked the lamp post down.

Answer: Speeding – -ing adjective (qualifies truck).

4. Speaking with your mouth full is a bad habit.

Answer: Speaking – Gerund (subject of is).

5. The pilgrims, boarding the buses, will be visiting a shrine.

Answer: Boarding – -ing adjective (qualifies pilgrims); Object: the buses.

6. The dentist warned Shanti about eating sweets all the time.

Answer: Eating – Gerund (object of the preposition about); Object: sweets.

7. Nowadays, many people choose acting as a career.

Answer: Acting – Gerund (object of the verb choose).

8. In the past, people were used to walking long distances and travelling was an adventure.

Answer: Walking – Gerund (object of the preposition to); Object: long distances.

Travelling – Gerund (subject of was).

9. Taking photographs of wildlife has now become a passion with many people. It is much better than hunting animals.

Answer: Taking – Gerund (subject of has become); Object: photographs of wildlife.

Hunting – Gerund (object of the preposition than); Object: animals.

10. Harsh loves building model aeroplanes and ships.

Answer: Building – Gerund (object of the verb loves); Object: model aeroplanes and ships.

11. Buying and selling is what a trader does.

Answer: Buying and selling – Gerunds (subject of the verb is).

12. You can never solve a problem by avoiding it. Facing it squarely is much better.

Answer: Avoiding – Gerund (object of the preposition by); Object: it.

Facing – Gerund (subject of the verb is); Object: it.

13.Charles Dickens was very good at reading out his own stories.

Answer: Reading – Gerund (object of the preposition at).

14.Snoring is a disease that can be cured nowadays.

Answer: Snoring – Gerund (subject of the verb is).

15.He is so fond of hearing his own voice that once he starts speaking, he does not want to stop.

Answer: Hearing – Gerund (object of the preposition of); Object: his own voice.

Speaking – Gerund (object of the verb starts).